Secure Enterprise Mail Migration

A practical Zimbra to Mailcow migration framework

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Migration scope

Mailboxes are only part of the move

Inventory accounts, aliases, quotas and application senders.

Track calendars, contacts, rules and shared access separately.

Assign an owner to every exception before the delivery switch.

Target readiness

The pilot must prove the whole service

Validate hostname and certificates with real clients.

Test inbound mail, authenticated submission and IMAP access.

Confirm relay sender identities and restricted administrator access.

Migration sequence

Each stage needs an exit condition

1. Pilot representative users and large mailboxes
2. Copy mail and record results for every account
3. Reconcile the final incremental synchronisation
4. Change delivery routing in the approved window
5. Verify mail flow and obtain service acceptance

Sender authentication

Delivery evidence starts in message headers

SPF checks an SMTP envelope or HELO identity.

DMARC requires SPF or DKIM to pass with domain alignment.

Validate every approved sender route before tightening policy.

Acceptance and recovery

Mailbox counts need context

Compare folders, dates, flags and attachment samples.

Test sent items, search, webmail and desktop clients.

Keep a restore test and a rollback plan that accounts for new mail.

Operational handover

Ownership continues after cutover

Assign certificate, backup, queue and capacity monitoring owners.

Revoke temporary migration access after acceptance.

Retire the source only after the agreed retention period.

Reference material

Practitioner guidance for infrastructure teams

Mailcow documentation: Advanced SSL
RFC 7208: Sender Policy Framework
RFC 9989: DMARC

This presentation describes a proposed operational framework.
It contains no client data or measured project results.